



Horacio Samaniego <horacio.samaniego@gmail.com>

CLAS GIS webinar - November 30

Diana Schwartz Francisco <dischwartz@uchicago.edu>

Tue, Oct 13, 2020 at 12:54 PM

To: Horacio Samaniego <horacio.samaniego@gmail.com>

Cc: Lindsay Ortega <lindsayortega@uchicago.edu>, Sarah Newman <senewman@uchicago.edu>

Dear Horacio,

Thank you again for your willingness to present during CLAS's GIS-focused webinar series this fall! We're very much looking forward to hosting you virtually and to hearing more about your exciting work.

I've cc'd here Sarah Newman (Assistant Professor of Anthropology) and Lindsay Ortega (Student Affairs Coordinator at CLAS). Sarah, Lindsay, and I have been working together on the series.

I wanted to confirm a few details with you so that we can finalize our preparations for the event:

1. We're planning to schedule your presentation for Monday, November 30 from 12:40-1:30 PM CST (times have shifted a bit recently due to new COVID-19 schedules). Please confirm the day and time still work for you. We'd like you to present for **30 minutes**, which will leave 20 minutes for Q&A.
2. Can you send us a title, abstract, and image by **October 20** so that we can promote the presentation? We'll also plan to make the webinar available to your team members and/or colleagues working on related projects, their home institutions, and whoever else you may wish to invite, and will share those announcements with them. Additionally, we can make arrangements for live simultaneous translation into Spanish or Portuguese if you would like as well.
4. Finally, we are hoping to put a recording of the webinar on the CLAS webpage, along with related resources for researchers who may be interested in pursuing new or different avenues of spatial analyses in their work, especially during this time when field or archival work is limited for many. If there are particular datasets or other resources that have been key in your own research or that might be of use to other scholars working in Latin America, we'd love to accompany your video with a list of those links on the CLAS site.

Thank you again for working with us!

All my best,
Diana

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☐ Dialogue ☐ Outreach

CLAS GIS in Latin America: Functional Definition of City Limits, or How to Define the Urban Extent in the Age of Smartphones and Urban Scaling

Outreach — architexturez.net sent on 27th November 2020 by
Architexturez Research

The University of Chicago's Center for Latin American Studies and Department of Anthropology are delighted to invite you to our third webinar on innovative research that combines traditional strategies (ethnography, interviews, archival research, archaeological fieldwork, etc.) with spatial analysis.

Horacio Samaniego (Universidad Austral de Chile),
"Functional Definition of City Limits, or How to Define
the Urban Extent in the Age of Smartphones and Urban
Scaling"

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Defining city limits is an important issue when it comes to planning cities that will match the social and economic activity patterns of urban dwellers. While this issue has historically been left to administrative criteria, varying significantly across countries and political systems, the current availability of Information and Communication Technologies (ICT) now permits the development of new quantitative approaches to unveil how social dynamics relate to urban infrastructure.

Starting from the premise that ICT provides the potential to portray more accurate descriptions of urban systems when using the empirical analysis of millions of anonymized traces left by urbanites and their cellphones, we propose a conceptually simple computational technique to define urban boundaries for conurbations

with more than 100,000 inhabitants in Chile. We use complex networks analyses of individual travel trajectories to identify places of higher concurrency and functional importance across cities and urban scaling theory as a diagnostic tool allowing to distinguish urban from non-urban locations.

We propose that our method provides a functional definition of urban boundaries and suggests an explicit implementation of urban scaling that uses the increasingly available non-conventional datasets describing cities as complex systems.

Discussion will be in English with translations in Spanish available.

External Links

- **Event Registration**

Event Date

30th November 2020

12:40 PM in Central Time (US and Canada)

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